

Journeys

Unit 7 of 12 · Grammar Study Sheet

Compare animals, places and ways of travelling using comparatives and superlatives.

What you will be able to do

- ✓ Use comparative adjectives to compare two things
- ✓ Use superlative adjectives to compare one thing with all others
- ✓ Use everyday adjectives and their opposites
- ✓ Talk about ways of travelling
- ✓ Talk about money (borrow, lend, change, cash, credit card)
- ✓ Make polite requests (Can I...? Could I...?)

4 lessons in this unit

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Topics: *adjectives · animal journeys · comparative adjectives · stressed and weak syllables*

Vocabulary — Adjectives & opposites

clean ↔ dirty	difficult ↔ easy	fast ↔ slow	safe ↔ dangerous
cold ↔ hot	huge ↔ tiny	long ↔ short	

Use these adjectives to describe commutes, transportation, cities, and the weather.

Vocabulary — Animal journeys

saiga antelope (35 km/day from Central Asia)	loggerhead turtle (~14,000 km migration/ 15 years)
calf (baby saiga)	

Every year, animals around the world go on long, difficult journeys called migrations.

Pronunciation — Stressed and weak syllables

In long words, ONE syllable is STRESSED (louder, longer, clearer). Other syllables are WEAK — often with the schwa /ə/.

- AFrica /'æfrɪkə/ — stress on AF; final "a" is /ə/ schwa
- EUrope /'jʊərəp/ — stress on EU; "rope" is weak /rəp/
- ausTRAlia — stress on TRA
- anTARCTica — stress on TARC
- "than" between comparatives is weak: /ðən/ (NOT /ðæn/)

Comparative adjectives

Use the comparative to compare TWO things or groups. Add "than" after the comparative.

short	+ -er (big → bigger, cheap → cheaper, fast → faster)
-e	+ -r (safe → safer)
cons.+y	-y → -ier (easy → easier)
long	more + adjective (expensive → more expensive)
irreg.	good → better, bad → worse

Examples:

- Turtles have longer journeys than tree frogs.
- Tree frogs have shorter journeys than saiga antelopes.
- The female saiga's journey is more dangerous than the male's.
- Australia is hotter than Antarctica.
- Rock climbing is more fun than surfing. (opinion)

Lesson 7b · The deepest place on Earth

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Topics: ways of traveling · superlative adjectives · Mariana Trench

Vocabulary — Ways of traveling — collocations

go BY + bicycle/train/car / travel BY + train/bus/plane/boat / take a taxi/a bus/the train / walk / ride · drive · fly

James Cameron travelled to the Mariana Trench — the deepest place in the ocean — in his submarine, the Deepsea Challenger. He's also the filmmaker behind Titanic and Avatar.

Superlative adjectives

Use the superlative to compare ONE thing with ALL the other things in a group. Use "the" before the superlative.

short	the + -est (big → the biggest, fast → the fastest)
-e	the + -st (safe → the safest)
cons.+y	-y → -iest (easy → the easiest)
long	the most + adjective (the most expensive)
irreg.	good → the best, bad → the worst

Examples:

- The Mariana Trench is the deepest place in the ocean.
- This fish has the biggest teeth of any fish for its size.
- Titanic is the most popular movie by James Cameron.
- Avatar was the most expensive movie.
- Dublin is the most famous city in Ireland.

Lesson 7c · Visit Colombia!

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Topics: Colombia · word focus: time

Vocabulary — Colombian cities

Bogotá (capital)	Cartagena (Caribbean port, historic city)	Medellín (city, coffee, sculpture)	Calles (salsa, music, dance festivals)
Ciudad Perdida ("Lost City", 4-day trek, 1,241 steps)			

Colombia has more than just Bogotá. Each city has its own character — beaches, sculptures, salsa, or ancient ruins.

Word focus: time

Time pairs with different verbs and prepositions to make common phrases.

Examples:

- have a good time = enjoy yourself / have fun
- have time FOR + noun (have time for sports)

- spend time + -ing / with (spend time with family)
- save time = finish in less time (save time by taking a taxi)

Lesson 7d · Travel money + travel blog + final journey

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Topics: money · making requests · travel blog · so and because · video lesson · final journey · sockeye salmon

Vocabulary — Money (7d)

borrow (you take from someone)	lend (you give to someone)	cash (notes + coins)	credit card
change dollars INTO euros	spend money ON	pay BY credit card / pay FOR ticket	buy something
ATM (cash machine)			

Common confusion: **BORROW** = take temporarily / **LEND** = give temporarily. "Can you **LEND** me \$10?" / "Can I **BORROW** \$10?"

Vocabulary — Video — sockeye salmon (7f)

skin	shallow ↔ deep	smooth ↔ rough	decay (body breaks down)
lay eggs	turn (change colour)	brown bears	one in a thousand

In Alaska, sockeye salmon swim up shallow rivers to lay their eggs. Only one in every thousand finishes the journey — many are caught by brown bears.

Real life — Making requests (7d)

Polite request: Can I...? / Can you...? / Could I...? — followed by the base verb.

Ask	Can I change ...? / Can you give me ...? / Could I have ...?
Yes	Yes, of course. / Sure. / Certainly.
No	I'm sorry, but ... / I'm afraid I don't ...

Examples:

- Can I change one hundred dollars into euros? — Yes, of course.
- Can you give me the euros in tens?
- Could I borrow your phone, please?
- I'm sorry, but I don't have any change.

Writing skill — so and because (7e)

BECAUSE gives the REASON. **SO** gives the ACTION/RESULT. Choose based on what comes next.

because	action, BECAUSE + reason
so	reason, SO + action

Examples:

- We called a taxi **BECAUSE** we were late for the meeting. (action + reason)
- The train was late, **SO** we waited on the platform. (reason + action)

- I felt sorry for the bus driver BECAUSE he looked sad.
- I wanted a hot meal, SO I left the bus.
- It started raining, SO they ran home.